

Risk-Based Testing

How to prioritize testing when time, environments or capacity are limited.

Risk in testing

A simple approach combines likelihood and impact. Areas with high impact and high likelihood usually deserve greater attention.

What to consider

Business criticality, defect history, complexity, recent changes, integrations, usage volume, security and recoverability.

Risk-based regression

When there is not enough time to run everything, prioritize critical paths, changes, affected integrations and historically fragile areas. Clearly record what remains uncovered.

Communication

A risk matrix helps explain why tests were prioritized, but it does not replace professional judgment or product context.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

"We did not have time to test everything" should become an explicit coverage and risk decision, not an end-of-cycle surprise.